



Dreamtime

The Aborigines believe that their knowledge, faith, and practices are linked to the stories of creation, which are known as *Dreamtime* or *Dreaming*. **Ancestral** spirits came to Earth and created the land, animals, and plants. They taught the people how to live with the **Earth** and to respect it. The **Dreamtime** stories are still told today and are central to Aboriginal culture.

STORYTELLING

The Dreamtime stories explain how people should behave, live, and respect the land. These stories are passed down from generation to generation and relate to a large part of everyday life. The elders take every opportunity to teach children about the way of life of their people and, through story and song, have kept alive their traditions and heritage over thousands of years.

ULURU

All over Australia there are many sacred sites and *Dreamtime tracks*, which are the paths taken by the spirits when they created the land. Uluru is a sacred rock for the Aboriginal peoples of the Central Desert. It is rich in mythology and the caves are filled with ancient rock art depicting Dreamtime stories. In 1985 the site was returned to the Aboriginal people and the caves can only be visited by initiated Aborigines.



MIMI

The Mimi are spirits believed to live in Northern Australia. They are always carved or painted as tall, thin beings. When the first people arrived in Australia it is said that the Mimi spirits taught them how to live off the land. They showed them how to hunt, cook, and respect the Earth that they live on. They also taught the people how to paint. The Mimi are believed to be mischievous, but harmless spirits.